AlumniConnect User Manual

Contents

Welcome to AlumniConnect **2**

1 Getting Started **2**
- 1.1 Creating Your Account . . . 2
- 1.2 Logging In . . . 2
- 1.3 Password Recovery . . . 2

2 Features by Role **2**
- 2.1 For Students . . . 2
- 2.2 For Alumni . . . 3
- 2.3 For Faculty . . . 4
- 2.4 For Administrators . . . 5

3 How to Use Key Features **5**
- 3.1 Managing Your Profile . . . 5
- 3.2 Connecting with Others . . . 6
- 3.3 Sharing Content . . . 6
- 3.4 Using Messenger . . . 6
- 3.5 Participating in Polls . . . 6
- 3.6 Finding Opportunities . . . 6
- 3.7 Exploring Institutional Board . . . 7
- 3.8 Accessibility & Notifications . . . 7

4 Best Practices and Tips **7**

5 Need Help? **8**

6 Privacy and Security **8**

Thank You **8**

About AlumniConnect

Welcome to AlumniConnect, the official platform for Indian Institute of Information Technology (IIIT) Allahabad alumni, students, and faculty to connect, share, and grow together. This manual will guide you through all the features and functionalities of the website in a simple, step-by-step way.

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1 Getting Started

1.1 Creating Your Account

- Visit AlumniConnect and click **"Register"**
- Fill in your details and verify your email using the verification link sent to your email
- After registration, your account request will be reviewed by the **Head Admin** for approval
- Once approved, you will receive a confirmation email informing you that your account has been successfully activated
- If you do not receive a link, check your spam folder

1.2 Logging In

- Click **"Login"** and enter your credentials

1.3 Password Recovery

- Click **"Forgot Password"** to reset via email

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2 Features by Role

2.1 For Students

As a student, you can access core networking and learning features:

1. **Profile Management**
    - Create and edit your profile
    - Add your education details
    - Showcase your skills and interests

2. **Networking**
    - Browse the Alumni Directory
    - Send friend requests to alumni and peers
    - View friend suggestions
3. **Communication**
    - Use the Messenger to chat
    - Participate in group conversations
4. **Learning & Support**
    - Ask questions in the Doubt Room
    - Access the Resource Hub
    - Connect with mentors
5. **Content**
    - View community posts and updates
    - Browse the Gallery
6. **Career Exploration**
    - View job postings
    - Learn about upcoming events
    - Participate in post-webinar doubt discussions for a limited duration
    - Ask for referrals from alumni
7. **Community Exploration**
    - View Stories from alumni
    - See their achievements
    - Connect with alumni

2.2 For Alumni

1. **All Student Features**
    - Access to all features available to students
2. **Story Sharing**
    - Share your professional journey through Stories
    - Inspire current students with your experiences

3. **Achievement Showcase**
    - Submit your professional achievements
    - Celebrate publications, awards, and milestones
4. **Mentorship**
    - Offer guidance to students
    - Share career advice and insights
    - Post job openings
    - Provide referrals
5. **Polling**
    - Participate in polls and provide useful insights
    - Share information about current industry trends
6. **Alumni Support**
    - Indicate how you can contribute to the institution through selectable options
    - Choose from activities such as mentorship, referrals, event participation, and other support areas
    - Helps the institute identify and utilize alumni contributions effectively

2.3 For Faculty

1. **All Student Features**
    - Access to all features available to students
2. **Mentorship Dashboard**
    - Manage your mentorship activities
    - Connect with students seeking guidance
3. **Achievement Showcase**
    - Submit your professional achievements
    - Celebrate publications, awards, and milestones
4. **Resource Sharing**
    - Contribute to the Resource Hub
    - Share educational materials

2.4 For Administrators

Administrators (including Head Admin) have full access to manage the platform:

1. **All Features**
   - Access to all features available to Students, Alumni, and Faculty
2. **User Management**
   - Oversee user accounts and profiles
   - Manage permissions and roles
   - Approve join requests for new members
3. **Content Moderation**
   - Review and approve posts
   - Manage showcase pages
   - Handle achievement submissions
4. **Head Admin Analytics Dashboard**
   - View complete list of participants
   - Track join dates and timelines
   - Monitor total active members
   - Generate platform usage reports
5. **Event Administration**
   - Create institutional events
   - Manage event analytics
6. **Job Board Management**
   - Post and manage job opportunities
   - Archive old listings

3 How to Use Key Features

3.1 Managing Your Profile

1. Go to your **Dashboard** (click your name in the top right)
2. Click **"Edit Profile"**
3. Update your information
4. Add experience or education using the respective options
5. Click **"Save"** to update

3.2 Connecting with Others

1. Visit the **Alumni Directory**
2. Use filters (batch, branch, location)
3. View profiles
4. Click **"Send Friend Request"** to connect

3.3 Sharing Content

1. Go to **"Create Post"**
2. Choose a topic (e.g., Placements, Research)
3. Write your post and add attachments
4. Click **"Post"** to share

3.4 Using Messenger

1. Click **"Messenger"** in navigation
2. Select or start a conversation
3. Type message and press Enter
4. Create group chats using **"Create Group"**
5. Receive real-time notifications for messages

3.5 Participating in Polls

1. Visit the **Polls** page
2. View active polls
3. Vote by selecting an option
4. Create your own poll using **"Create Poll"**

3.6 Finding Opportunities

1. View job postings
2. Learn about upcoming events and webinars
3. Ask for referrals from alumni
4. Participate in post-webinar doubt discussions for a limited duration

3.7 Exploring Institutional Board

1. Navigate to the Institutional Board section from the dashboard
2. View the institute timeline including major milestones and events
3. Explore achievements, awards, and recognitions of students, alumni, and faculty
4. Access important announcements and institutional highlights
5. Use **Institute GPT** to explore institute-related information interactively
6. Retrieve details about institute history, events, and general information through AI assistance

3.8 Accessibility & Notifications

- Platform works seamlessly on mobile, tablet, and desktop
- Responsive design adapts to all screen sizes
- Stay updated with:
  - Friend requests and acceptances
  - New messages
  - Post likes and comments
  - Event invitations
  - Achievement approvals
- Access notifications via the bell icon in the top navigation

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4 Best Practices and Tips

- **Keep your profile updated** – This helps others connect with you
- **Be respectful** – Follow community guidelines in all interactions
- **Use appropriate topics** – Post in relevant categories for better reach
- **Network actively** – Connect with people from your batch and interests
- **Share positively** – Celebrate achievements and opportunities
- **Report issues** – Use the Help section or contact administrators for problems

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5 Need Help?

- Check the **Help** section on the website
- Visit the **Doubt Room** for questions
- Contact administrators for technical issues
- Use the **AI Help** feature for assistance

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6 Privacy and Security

- Your personal information is protected
- Use strong, unique passwords
- Log out when using shared devices
- Report any suspicious activity
- Review the privacy policy for details

Thank you for being part of AlumniConnect!